

Chapter – 6: Adolescence : A Stage of Change and Growth

- Journey of plant – begins – germination of seeds
- Proper nourishment – seed becomes sapling – matures – young plant
- This journey – marked – specific changes
- Some visible changes – increase in height, more leaves, flowers, fruits, new seeds
- Very unlikely – seedling – develop capacity – produce own seeds – just after germination
- Seeds – grow – reach maturity – become capable – produce seeds
- Similarly – animals – grow – reach maturity – become capable – reproduce
- Some animals – lay eggs – hatch into young ones – others (humans) – give birth to young ones
- Both cases – young ones – grow size, develop – over time
- Journey of life – humans – divided – diff. stages – infancy, childhood, adolescence, adulthood, old age
- Each person – experience stages – own pace – duration – each stage – vary – person to person
- Infancy to adulthood – our body – various changes
- Until – 10-12 years – most changes – height and weight
- After this – other noticeable changes – marks adolescence
- This period – rapid growth, development – between ages – 10-19
- Humans – like other living beings – cannot reproduce just after birth
- Their bodies – grow – reach maturity – capable – reproduction
- Humans – grow, develop – experience – physical, emotional, behavioural changes
- Some changes – visible clearly – others – internal, may be unnoticed
- This chapter – explore adolescence – understand imp. – learn to handle it

Growing with Age: The Teenage Years

- Summer vacation – Venkatesh visits grandparents – enters house – 12-year-old cousin – Devyani greets him
 - Devyani – Venkatesh – thin moustache – voice – also changed
 - Venkatesh – Devyani – so tall
- Activity –
 - Take – jar, some paper slips
 - Write changes – noticed in students – Grade 5 to 8 – height, strength, behaviour – avoid – writing names
 - Fold slips – place them – jar
 - Mix – all slips – unfold them – separately – **discuss** – changes mentioned in slips
- You also experience – these changes? – if yes – you are reaching this stage
- This stage – starts – around 10 years – continue upto – 19 years
- This stage – development – b/w – childhood, adulthood – called – **adolescence**
- Analyzing activity – notice following –
 - Increase in height –
 - Since birth – body – continuous growth, development
 - BUT – increase in height – more prominent – adolescence
 - Changes in body structure, weight gain, strength –
 - Boys grow – along with height – gain weight, shoulders broaden, chest widens
 - Girls – also – height, weight changes – along with – development – breasts
 - Changes in voice –

- Adolescent boys – growth – voice box – voice – hoarse
- Voice box – structure – our throat – helps us – speak
- Growth – bump in throat region – Adam's apple
- Girls – voice box grows – not as big as boys – slight change in voice
- Appearance of hair in diff. parts of body –
 - Both – boys, girls – experience growth – hair – diff. parts of bodies – armpits, pubic region
 - Boys – develop – facial hair – later – grows – moustache, beard
 - Some boys – also develop – chest, back hair
 - Variations – timing, appearance – hair growth – normal
- Changes in facial skin: emergence of pimples –
 - Another common occurrence – adolescent years – skin condition – acne – small reddish pimples
 - Commonly visible – face
 - Acne – cause – increase – oily secretions – skin – during adolescence – clog skin pores – infection
 - Acne – condition – pimples – manifestation
- These changes – easily observable
- Some changes – voice change, facial, chest hair – boys – development of breasts – girls – not involved directly – reproduction
- BUT – these changes – distinguish – males from females – **secondary sexual characteristics**
- Secondary characteristics – natural signs – body – preparing – adulthood – mark – onset – puberty
- **Puberty** – stage – body – adolescent – external, internal changes – develop into adult – reproduce

Changes that Indicate Reproductive Capability

- Adolescence – marked – observable changes – internal changes – not visible
- One such change – maturation – various parts – process – reproduction
- Both – boys, girls – experience changes – natural part – growing up
- Imp. internal change – adolescent girls – **menstrual cycle**
- This cycle – recurs – 28-30 days – commonly known – periods
- Many girls – longer, shorter cycles – 21-35 days
- This cycle – imp. natural process – signs – good reproductive health
- Phase of cycle – blood discharge from body – **menstruation** – last – 3-7 days
- Some girls – feel pain, discomfort – lower abdomen – these days
- Age – 45-55 – menstruation stops – marking – end – reproductive capability – women's life
- Adolescence – not only about – physical, reproductive changes – BUT also – emotional, behavioural changes

Breaking myths about menstruation

- Many wrong beliefs – menstruation – lead – unnecessary fear, shame, guilt
- These beliefs – give rise – myths, taboos
- Among such myths, taboos – physical isolation – menstruating girls – still exists
- Menstruation – natural – myths – no scientific basis
- Encouraging scientific outlook – menstruation – help society – promote reproductive health – contribute – healthier lifestyle

Emotional and Behavioural Changes in Adolescents

- Activity –
 - Take a moment – think – any changes – emotions, behaviour – past years
 - These changes – exciting, confusing – may be both
 - List emotional changes – with probable effects – ways – positive growth, development
- Discuss – changes – mentioned above – you explored – diverse behavioural changes
- Adolescence – marked – stronger emotions than childhood
- These emotions – affect behaviour – developing deeper interest – new areas
- Understand – emotions influence behaviour, actions – help us – make better choices

Making Adolescence a Joyful Experience

- Journey – adolescence – unique experience
- Heightened curiosity – this stage – adolescents – new viewpoint – everything
- Good habits, thoughtful decisions, small actions – powerful positive impact – overall well-being

Meeting nutritional needs

- Grade 6 chapter – mindful eating – learnt – need – healthy diet
- Adolescence – period of growth, development – marked by – several changes – nutritious diet – utmost importance
- Activity –
 - List – healthy food sources, their nutrients, how they help – growth, development – based on local availability

Personal hygiene

- Personal hygiene – crucially imp. – adolescence
- Maintain body hygiene – armpits, pubic region – protect us – potential infections
- Girls – maintain hygiene – menstruation – essential – comfort, health
- Menstrual hygiene – maintained – items – sanitary pads, reusable cloth pads
- Govt. – attempts – provide these products – free, low price – improve menstrual hygiene
- Society – make efforts – ensure availability – necessary facilities – schools, public places – promote menstrual hygiene
- Imp. – dispose – used pads – properly – wrap them – newspaper – dispose in dustbin
- This way of disposing – ensure – community health, environmental cleanliness
- Now-a-days – biodegradable pads – also available – environment friendly

Physical activities

- Regular exercise, phy. activities – also imp. – adolescence
- These activities – keeps body fit – build up stamina – boost your mood

Balanced social life

- We all – live in society – interact with each other – day-to-day life
- Be polite, respectful – helps create – safe environment
- Adolescence – stage – new experiences – be very thoughtful, responsible – interact with others
- This time – adolescents – may feel – attraction – their peers – mimic behaviour

- Today – modern tech. – online platforms – available to all – obtain info., make connections, interact, share info.
- Use these platforms – responsibly – collective well-being – all of us
- Sometimes – knowingly or not – use social media – carelessly – seeking guidance – elders, teachers – help – effective use – these platforms
- Activity –
 - Work in grps. – **design** – posters, pamphlets – various aspects – responsible social media use
 - Paste them – designated places – school
 - Also – make a list – dos and don'ts

Avoiding harmful substances – learn to say NO

- Some people – incl. peers – tempt, persuade, force, create pressure – consume – harmful substances – *gutka*, tobacco, cigarettes, *beedi*, alcohol, illegal drugs
- Adolescence – marked – curiosity, excitement – adolescents – might be influenced – such people
- These substance – harmful – phy, mental health – ALSO – addictive
- Once – start consuming – develop strong urge – use again and again – called – **substance abuse**
- Using these substances – cause serious health problems – breathing difficulties, memory loss, damage to lungs
- Imp. – avoid substances – stay healthy – make healthy choices
- Imp. – remain firm, confident – say NO
- First step – overcoming addiction – seeking help, support – family, friends, parents, teachers
- Counselling, medical advice – also helpful – handling these situations
- Your health – your hands – choose wisely

The 'Why' Question for Adolescence

- Many changes – adolescence – menstruation, other signs – puberty – mainly – **hormones** – certain chem. – produced in body
- Hormones – crucial role – regulating – growth, development – contribute – proper functioning – body
- Produces – diff. parts – released – appropriate times – responding to signals – brain
- Some hormones – influence – mood, behaviour
- Staying informed – seeking support, guidance – making healthy decisions – build strong foundation